Plotweaver LaTeX Document Class

This file serves as a tutorial and example for how to use the `plotweaver` document class to typeset homebrew content in the style of Plotweaver RPG and Cosmere RPG games.

Introduction

The `plotweaver` document class is a free and open source resource which uses LaTeX to emulate the style of the Plotweaver RPG and Cosmere RPG rule books. This allows you to focus on writing and creating content without the hassle of formatting each document. To use this document class, you will need to have LaTeX installed, which can be downloaded at the official LaTeX project website. If you're not familiar with LaTeX, a full installation is recommended. Another non-local option is to upload the class and package files to an online LaTeX editor such as Overleaf. Please note that online editors may or may not be free. Regardless of installation choice, you will need to use LuaLaTeX as the compiler.

The philosophy of this document class and its accompanying packages is to be as simple to use as possible while remaining as modular and flexible as possible. It is also still under active development, particularly with respect to the talent tree boxes. Contributions are welcome on this project's GitHub repository.

Example Usage

For full documentation, please see `plotweaver.pdf`. For an example of how to use this document class to generate character sheets, please see `character-sheet.tex`.

Character Sheets

You can make a character sheet using the `MakeCharacterSheet` command if `character-sheet` is passed into the document class options. It will calculate derived attributes for you, and you can set it to use the terminology for Stormlight Archive or Mistborn instead of the generic Plotweaver terms. See `character-sheet.tex` for an example of how to use this command. In the future, I intend to make the sheet more customizable.

Color Schemes

You can switch color schemes by passing an option to the document class. The default is `stormlight`. You can also use `mistborn` or `ariandor`. You can also define your own color schemes.

Icons

Icons for activations and plot die are specified with `forever`, `freeAction`, `action`, `doubleAction`, `tripleAction`, `reaction`, `opportunity`, and `complication`. They look like this:

The complication commands can take a number or be left blank. Numbers look like this: 2 . You can also make larger complication symbols with `complicationDice`:

Icons are also provided for the metals (both allomantic and feruchemical) in Mistborn and the radiant orders (along with their corresponding surges) in Stormlight Archive. Examples can be seen in Table 1. The matching set of icons will be loaded with the chosen color scheme, but you can also manually load each icon package.

Feature Boxes

Three feature boxes are specified using `tcolorbox`. They are `featureBox`, `leftBox`, `rightBox`, `calloutBox`, `altcalloutBox`, and `paperBox`. You can also use the command `\statBox` to nicely align a left and right box. These boxes support upper and lower content, but you don't have to specify both.

Lists

Lists can be made using the `itemize` environment. They will automatically use the matching color scheme.

- Item 1
- Item 2
- Item 3

Statblocks

Statblocks can be made using the `\MakeStatBlock` command. Similar to the character sheet command, you pass in the attributes, features, and actions for the statblock as key-value pairs. This command currently does not calculate derived attributes, as those tend to not follow the derivation formulae as strictly. You can also change the number of columns in the statblock. Thanks to `cosmicducks` for contributing this command!

Table 1: Example Table

Heading 1	Heading 2	Heading 3	Heading 4
Lipsum	Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit.	1234	5678
Lipsum	Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit.	1234	5678
Lipsum	Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit.	1234	5678
Lipsum	Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit.	1234	5678

THIS IS A CAPTION THAT IS PLACED BELOW THE TABLE

Example Character

Tier 2 Boss - Gargantuan Animal

Physical			Mental			Spiritual		
STR	DEF	SPD	INT	DEF	WIL	AWA	DEF	PRE
5	18	3	2	15	3	3	15	2

Health: 40 (20-60) **Focus:** 5 **Essence:** 5

Movement: 30 ft.

Senses: 20 ft. (sight)

Physical Skills: Heavy Weaponry +9, Thievery +5

Mental Skills: Discipline +5

Spiritual Skills: Insight +7, Perception +7

Metallic Art Skills: Allomancy +6 (3 ranks; Tin)

FEATURES

Example feature. Feature text goes here.

ACTIONS

▷ **Example Action.** Action text goes here.

Tables

Tables can be created using `plotable`. This uses `nicematrix` under the hood. Like usual, you can refer to Table 1 with a label.

Talent Paths

TikZ is used to make the talent paths. You can add a photo as the background, if desired. See the talent path page for a sample talent path.

Feature Box

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Sub Feature

Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetuer adipiscing elit. Ut purus elit, vestibulum ut, placerat ac, adipiscing vitae, felis. Curabitur dictum gravida mauris.

Stat One

These boxes can have different content...

Stat Two

...and still end up the same height! Even when one is multiple lines.

Callout Box

This is a callout box. It will be as wide as the text (i.e., `\linewidth`) unless you pass a width to the `tcolorbox` environment.

You can also have a callout box that will float next to the text. To do this, you need to use the `wrapfig` package. Set the width in the `wrapfigure` environment and then let the `tcolorbox` fill the total width.

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Alt Callout Box

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Torn Paper Box

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The Borders of Subsequent Boxes Match

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Samples of the Mistborn and Stormlight icons.

Mistborn Symbols

Steel	Terris	Meaning
		Lerasium (A)
		Iron (B)
		Unknown C (C)
		Copper (D)
		Tin (E)
		Malatium (F)
		Cadmium (G)
		Unknown H (H)
		Unknown J (J)
		Bendalloy (K)
		Zinc (L)
		Gold (M)
		Electrum (N)
		Pewter (O)
		Steel (P)
		Brass (R)
		Duralumin (S)
		Bronze (T)
		Atium (V)
		Chromium (W)
		Unknown X (X)
		Nicrosil (Y)
		Aluminum (Z)
		Ettmetal
|	-	Zero (0)

Stormlight Symbols

Surges		Radiant Order	
			Windrunners
			Skybreakers
			Dustbringers
			Edgedancers
			Truthwatchers
			Lightweavers
			Elsecallers
			Willshapers
			Stonewards
			Bondsmiths

★ **Key Talent** This is how you make a Key Talent.

∞ Forever

This is how you make a Talent box.

▷ Free Action

Prerequisite: Statistic +2

You can also specify a prerequisite for a Talent.

▶ Action

You can specify complications with a number 2 or with no numbers . You can also make dice style complications like this

4

⏩ Double Action

You can also specify when opportunities happen.

Triple Action

To make a Talent Tree, first specify all of the Talent nodes.

↩ Reaction

Then, you can use lines to connect the nodes.

Timelines

Timelines can be created using the `timeline` environment if `timeline` is passed into the document class options. You can pass in arguments to determine the spacing between major and minor ticks with `major tick pattern` and adjust the overall scale with `scale`. Within the timeline environment, the start and end years are specified with the `era` command. Specific events are added aftwards with the `event` command. This allows for multiple eras to be chained together in a single timeline.

A Note on Compilation Times

For basic document, the compilation time with this document class should be fairly low. I have tried to keep all of the icon definitions separated off into their own setting specific packages to help with compilation times. The character sheet command is in its own separate package for that same reason. Slower compilation times are expected for documents that make heavy use of all of the various design elements provided. I have experimented with `memoize`, but it has compatibility issues with `tcolorbox` and requires additional setup on the user end. I have also experimented with `tikzexternalize`, but found its compilation times to be slower than without externalization.

There are a few other packages and strategies I may explore once this package is in a more mature state. If someone else has a successful strategy for improving compilation times, I am all ears. Otherwise, there are some caching strategies that can be implemented on the user end, though those are beyond the scope of my own documentation.